



YOU ARE **26 WEEKS AND 4 DAYS**

94 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

On this 3-D image each finger is held outstretched. Holding the fingers in this way for any length of time is tiring, so most of the time the hands are held with the wrists slightly flexed and the fingers bent, ready to grasp any object that floats into reach.

“Your baby’s reproductive organs are now in place; a boy’s testes have descended and a girl’s ovaries have all their follicles.”

If your baby is a boy, it’s at about this time that the testes complete their descent into the scrotum. This is often associated with a small amount of fluid around each testis called a “hydrocele.” This fluid will disappear naturally either before or after birth.

The cremaster muscle, part of the spermatic cord, is able to raise the testes back into the groin. This helps to regulate the temperature within the testes after birth, relaxing when cooling is needed. If your baby is slightly cool when examined, the cremaster muscle retracts the testes giving the impression of an undescended testes in your newborn baby.

Temperature control is not required in the uterus and the testes slowly move down into the scrotum. It is by no means unusual for one testis (or both) not to have descended at birth. Your doctor will check for this as part of the routine baby development checkup and confirm that both testes can be brought down into the scrotum.

Unlike the ovary, which already contains all of the egg-producing follicles that it will ever make, the testes do not start to make sperm until puberty.

Differences in the speed of growth and weight gain become more apparent now, and boys tend to be slightly heavier than girls at birth.

ASK A MOM

Is it normal to argue all the time when we should be happily looking forward to our baby’s arrival? It can be. Concerns about having a healthy baby and adjusting to parenthood were at the heart of most of our arguments. We found we had conflicting opinions about big child-rearing issues. I was sensitive, irritable, and moody and often snapped when I didn’t mean to.

We sat down and talked calmly and agreed to avoid areas of contention and compromise when it didn’t really matter. In the throes of a disagreement, I’d stop and think: I love this man, we’re having a baby together— is this really important? We also made time to do positive things together that we had enjoyed before I was pregnant, and tried to find opportunities to laugh, to